

Robin Alvarez

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Hiring Team, Platform Reliability

Helios Data, Lisbon

Dear Platform Reliability team,

Your posting asks for someone who can improve an on-call rotation, not merely survive one. That is the part of my last five years I would most want to be judged on, so I will argue it rather than list it.

When I took over tracking at Northwind, the rotation was waking someone most nights. The instinct in the room was to add process: a triage shift, a weekly review, a rota for the rota.

I argued the opposite. Almost none of what fired described a condition a human could act on, and the rest reached the wrong person. So we deleted alerts, and made the owning service answer for the ones that survived. The weekly page count fell by roughly three quarters and nobody added a meeting. That is a judgment call before it is an engineering one.

I can make that call because I have not stopped reading the code. I designed the event schema our tracking path still runs on, and moved the product off a shared database onto per-service ones without downtime. Your requirement that a manager review a design and disagree with it is the one I would want tested hardest.

You expect to grow by three this year. I have done that arithmetic, taking a team from four to seven, and the third hire is where a team's habits either set or scatter. I would want to know what yours are before adding anyone.

One thing I will not overstate: my Kubernetes experience is working knowledge. The migration ran on it, but I have never owned a cluster. Everything else in your requirements I have done directly.

I am a US citizen and would need sponsorship for Portugal, which your posting says you offer.

Sincerely,

Robin Alvarez